STEVEN GANDHAM

Software Engineer | Backend Systems and Cloud Architecture

stevengandham@gmail.com | (805) 660-3757 | linkedin.com/in/steven-s-gandham
github.com/stevengandham | stevengandham.com

SUMMARY

Software Engineer II at Realtor.com. I build the backend systems people rely on every day: user accounts and sign-in, customer communications, payments, security, customer support, and connections with partner companies. Promoted from Software Engineer I to II. Over my career, I have contributed to 70+ repositories and delivered 1,000+ fixes. I am known for communicating clearly, setting the right priorities, and focusing first on the work with the biggest impact, including fixing 200+ security vulnerabilities and finding $400K+ in savings. I also build AI tools that help other engineers get work from ticket to production faster and more safely.

SKILLS

Languages and Frameworks: JavaScript, Node.js, React, Python, SQL, Java, C, Bash
Cloud and Data: AWS Serverless, Lambda, Step Functions, S3, API Gateway, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, MS SQL
AI and Architecture: Claude Code Skills, Agentic AI, Event-Driven Systems, RESTful APIs, Auth0, SSO
Tools and Practices: Docker, Splunk, New Relic, SonarQube, Jenkins, CircleCI, ArgoCD, Swagger, Figma, Agile, Scrum

EXPERIENCE

Realtor.com — Software Engineer II — Aug 2024 - Present

- Delivered engineering work across account access, communications, payments, security, customer support, and partner systems.
- Built Claude Code skills and open-source workflows, from compliance checks to ticket-to-production delivery, that force-multiply the team and company.
- Fixed 200+ security vulnerabilities across 70+ projects to meet compliance requirements, adding unit tests, introducing SonarQube scanning, and rotating secrets.
- Redesigned how accounts and permissions work, replacing an old account-group system with a model based on customers and organizations, making access easier to manage across multiple customer portals and internal tools.
- Wrote architecture documentation and presented it company-wide, and mentored a new graduate hire and summer interns.

Realtor.com — Software Engineer I — Jul 2021 - Aug 2024

- Built sign-in and account access features, including login, single sign-on with Auth0, user invitations, impersonation, and permission controls, for 5+ new types of customers and businesses.
- Modernized a 15-year-old phone number and call-routing system, moving it from .NET to Node.js and retiring 4 old servers, reaching 90%+ test coverage.
- Found orphaned records that no one was tracking by analyzing data in Splunk, resulting in $400K+ in savings.
- Built and improved 7+ backend APIs in Node.js that connect databases and outside services, supporting a customer base of 1.5M+.
- Moved older AWS systems to a modern serverless setup using AWS Step Functions, replacing a long-running service process.

Scorpion.co — Web Development Intern — Jul 2019 - Sep 2019

- Built a tool that converts Word documents to the company web platform format, making the team 280% more efficient.
- Co-built a Chrome extension that converts selected web page elements into formatted HTML.

Realtor.com — Engineering Intern — Summers 2017 and 2018

- Built systems on AWS that turn audio into text using Lambda, Transcribe, Comprehend, and S3, and tested new ideas using EC2, API Gateway, Firehose, SNS, and CloudWatch.

PROJECTS

LiDAR Navigation Lead, TEECOM SCOUT Autonomous Drone

- Led navigation work using 360-degree LiDAR data (RPLidar A3M1) to spot doorways, windows, and hallways and create 2D room maps, writing Python code that accounted for flight stability.

EDUCATION

Cal Poly, San Luis Obispo — B.S. Computer Engineering, 2016 - 2020